

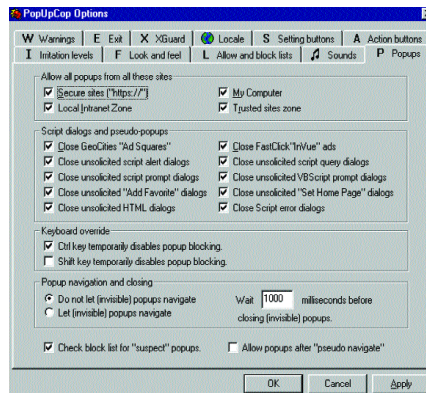


The flyout menu gives easy access to all the settings

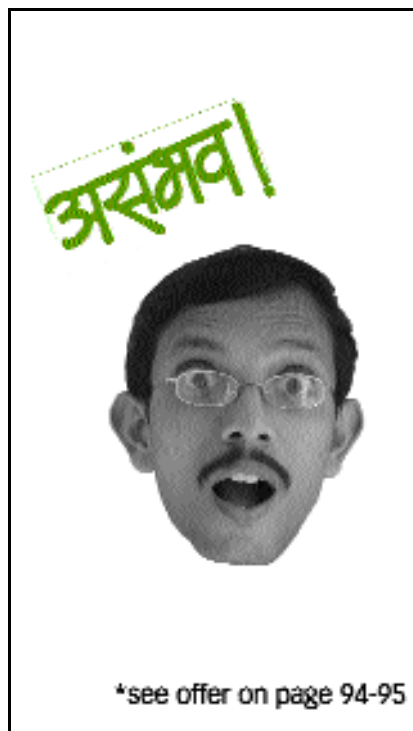
For the rest of us

For those who would like to continue using Internet Explorer, you need to install a third party pop-up blocker, such as PopUpCop. After installation, the software will add a toolbar within IE—if you do not see the toolbar within IE, from the top menu select **View > Toolbars > PopUpCop**.

The toolbar is very simple and easy to understand. There is a main button that is labelled PopUpCop, which shows a menu giving you the main program options. From here, you can set detailed options for all the program's aspects. The level of filtering can be easily set to one of the presets using a simple slider on the toolbar itself. The toolbar also has an indicator light that glows green if the page is free from pop-



PopUpCop's provides advanced options for how different types of pop-ups are dealt with



The Pop-Up Mafia

Pop-ups and pop-unders are usually advertisements, which most surfers don't care to see. Online advertising is accounted and paid for in one of two ways—the advertiser pays per click that leads to his site (click-through) or per time the ad is displayed (impression). The in-your-face manner of pop-ups makes the response in terms of click-throughs up to five times that of standard online advertising such as banners and buttons. Web sites can charge higher rates per impression of a pop-up as compared to a banner since the display is more prominent, and can-

not be missed by the surfer. This high return tempts Web sites to over-use the technique in a bid to increase their revenues. All this makes it pretty clear that pop-up advertising is here to stay. Besides the fact that pop-ups are just plain irritating and we don't want to see them, they also take up precious bandwidth, something some can scarcely afford. Web developers also have other annoying things like pages that automatically add themselves to your Favorites list or set themselves as your home page without your consent.

Quick Fix

Smart Popup killer is a very simple program without many options but is very effective at controlling pop-ups. After installation, it remains invisible until the Explorer is run. When launched, a small B in the taskbar shows that blocking is functional. Left-clicking will allow pop-ups and show as an A in the taskbar. If you think the filtration is too lenient or too harsh, change the level by right-clicking the tray icon and selecting from the menu that comes up. Smart Popup Killer also sports an allow list and a cookie manager.

ups, red if annoyances have been blocked on the page and yellow if there are annoyances present but not been blocked. There's a small double arrow (>>), which opens a fly-out menu with on, off, or partial filtering for all other annoyances that the program can block. This can be effectively used in conjunction with the indicator light. For example, you visit a site that you find interesting, but see that the indicator turns red. Clicking the indicator shows what's been blocked. You can simply disable blocking for those things and refresh the page to see what you missed.

The 'annoyances' PopUpCop will protect you from are numerous—images, background sounds, flash animations, scripts, browser re-sizing, and a host of other things can be enabled and disabled directly from the toolbar's fly-out menu. Use the program's detailed cookie manager to take charge of personal information contained in cookies. There is also a shortcut to the Favorites folder in Windows, a button to clear the browser's cache and an allow list for your trusted sites.

A good usability feature is the ability to add the site being currently visited to your Allow list, with just a couple of clicks from the toolbar. These sites get added to your safe list and the settings are remembered the next time you visit them. PopUpCop asks before blocking pop-ups, so you know when they are present and don't find out after they've been blocked. PopUpCop also has an auto-installer manager. This helps manage security when installing software from the Web using IE's auto install feature.

Using all this stopping power, you can enjoy a safe and embarrassment free surfing experience, and never worry about unwanted pop-ups again.

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